GLOBAL WEEK AHEAD

Sunday, 23 August 2026

Everything coming up. Week of Mon 24 August. All times GMT+8.

Weekend companion to the Daily Need to Know. Forward-looking; verify live prices and confirm scheduled times before acting.

SETUP SNAPSHOT

Where the majors sat as the **week of 17–21 Aug** closed — a second straight down week, salvaged by a Friday bounce as Treasury pledged bigger buybacks. Equities enter the new week firmer but into heavy event risk.

Instrument	Fri 21 Aug	Day	Context / into Monday
S&P 500	7,674	**+0.4%**	3rd straight weekly loss; Hedgeye range 7,610–7,835
Nasdaq Comp.*	≈26,170	**+0.4%**	NVDA (Wed) is the week's swing factor
Dow*	≈53,260	**+0.9%**	+~500pts Fri; snapped a 3-day skid
Russell 2000	3,006	**+0.5%**	Small-caps leading the bounce
US 10Y	4.71%	**≈flat**	30Y at ~2-decade high — long-end stress
US 2Y	4.24%	**+4bp**	Bear-steepening; front end anchored
DXY	98.8	**-0.3%**	~3-month low; yen/peso-intervention chatter
Gold	$4,645	**+1.6%**	Broke above top of risk range — momentum
Silver	$69	**-1.9%**	TREND still bullish (64–71)
WTI crude	$86.5	**-0.3%**	2nd weekly gain; Iran premium
Brent	$93.6	**-0.2%**	>$90 on Strait of Hormuz risk
Bitcoin	$77,300	**+7.7%**	Treasury buybacks + CLARITY Act push
VIX	15.4	**-3.7%**	Cheap into NVDA/PCE/Jackson Hole

**Nasdaq and Dow are approximate Friday closes reconciled from intraday and prior-session data; S&P 500 close confirmed. Verify live levels before acting.*

Futures / Asia open: Friday's rebound and the Bessent buyback backstop set a constructive-but-cautious tone. Expect a modestly firmer Monday Asia open on thin, pre-event liquidity; the tape will not commit ahead of **NVIDIA (Wed)**, **core PCE (Wed)** and **Jackson Hole (Fri)**. Gold and energy stay bid; the long end of the curve is the risk the whole complex is watching.

TL;DR

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> A five-day gauntlet decides whether the summer AI rally survives contact with a stressed bond market. **NVIDIA earnings (Wed after the close)** and **Fed Chair Warsh's Jackson Hole debut (Fri)** bracket the week, with **core PCE (Wed)** in between — all against a **Quad 3** backdrop of slowing growth and re-accelerating inflation as **Brent holds above $90** on the Iran standoff and the **30Y yield sits near a two-decade high**. Long-duration tech is the most exposed; gold, energy, defensives and equal-weight are where the regime points.

THE BIG PICTURE — WHAT TO WATCH

1. **NVIDIA earnings (Wed, after the close) — the AI referendum.** Guidance framed at ~**$91B** for the quarter; the Street is closer to **$93–95B**. The read on Blackwell ramp, Rubin roadmap, data-center demand and China is the single biggest driver of the week's tape.

> **Watch:** Options imply a large post-print move; a beat-and-raise revives breadth, a soft data-center or China line hits the whole complex. Semis (SNDK, MU, MRVL) are the tell.

2. **Jackson Hole — Warsh's debut (Fri).** Kevin Warsh's first keynote as Fed Chair (in office since 22 May). 2026 theme: **"Financial Innovation — Implications for Payments and Policy."** He has flagged a "big-picture" framework talk and that the Fed is "not constrained by market prices."

> **Watch:** Any hawkish-independence signal against a stagflationary backdrop. A framework-heavy speech that downplays near-term cuts would lift the dollar and pressure long-duration equities.

3. **The bond market is the boss.** The **30Y yield sits near its highest in ~two decades**; Treasury doubled long-dated buybacks to **$4B+** per operation to steady the tape. Supply lands **Tue (2Y, $69B), Wed (5Y, $70B), Thu (7Y, $44B)**.

> **Watch:** Auction tails or another leg up in the long end would override good news elsewhere — the mechanism that finally let bond stress "wash up" to stocks.

4. **Core PCE (Wed).** Consensus ~**+0.2% m/m**, core y/y around **3.3%**. With oil surging, an upside surprise validates the stagflation call and lifts hike odds.

> **Watch:** A hot print + hawkish Warsh + strong NVDA is the messy "good-news-is-bad-news" combination; a soft print is the relief valve.

5. **Oil & Iran — the inflation impulse.** Brent above $90 on a reinstated blockade, "economic D-Day" threats and Strait of Hormuz risk. Energy is the transmission belt into CPI/PCE.

> **Watch:** A run at $100 Brent would be an outright macro shock; XLE stays a regime-consistent long. Any de-escalation headline is the fade risk.

6. **Regime check — Quad 3.** Growth slowing, inflation re-accelerating. That points to commodities, gold/silver, defensives (XLV) and equal-weight/value over crowded long-duration growth.

> **Watch:** Leadership rotation: if gold and equal-weight (RSP) hold up while high-beta momentum keeps bleeding, the Quad-3 script is playing out.

ECONOMIC CALENDAR — THE WEEK AHEAD

Day-by-day, GMT+8 (US 8:30 AM ET releases land ~20:30 GMT+8 the same evening). Consensus shown where available; confirm against a live calendar.

Day (GMT+8)	Key releases / events	Why it matters
Mon 24	US Chicago Fed National Activity Index (Jul). Asia/China: quiet.	Low-impact opener; positioning day before the gauntlet.
Tue 25	US Consumer Confidence (Aug); New Home Sales (Jul); Case-Shiller 20-city (Jun); Richmond Fed. 2Y note auction $69B (≈01:00 Wed).	Consumer read post-Walmart miss; first supply test of a stressed curve.
Wed 26	US Core PCE (Jul, cons. +0.2% m/m / ~3.3% y/y); Personal Income & Spending; GDP Q2 2nd est. 5Y auction $70B. NVIDIA after the close.	Fed's preferred inflation gauge + the AI bellwether on the same day.
Thu 27	US Jobless Claims; Advance Goods Trade (Jul); KC Fed Mfg. 7Y auction $44B. Jackson Hole opens (evening ET).	Labor tell; final duration auction; symposium tone-setting.
Fri 28	Jackson Hole — Warsh keynote (Fri AM ET ≈ evening GMT+8); UMich final + inflation expectations. Japan: Tokyo CPI (Aug).	The policy event of the week; Asia inflation cross-check.

Note: China's official August PMIs publish the following Monday (31 Aug), just outside this window but a key month-end marker.

CENTRAL BANKS & POLICY EVENTS

No FOMC this week (next decision 15–16 Sep). The policy signal comes entirely from **Jackson Hole (27–29 Aug)** and Chair **Warsh's Friday keynote** — his first as Chair, and the market's first real look at his framework.

Prediction-market color: Polymarket is pricing roughly **88.8% odds of zero Fed cuts in 2026**, and the Sep meeting has been leaning toward **no change with a live tail of a hike** given the oil-driven inflation risk — an unusually hawkish distribution. Treat as sentiment, not forecast, and verify live.

> **Watch:** Fed speakers on the sidelines at Jackson Hole; any daylight between Warsh's framing and the White House's rate stance. USD and the front end are the fastest reactors.

EARNINGS ON DECK

The marquee: NVIDIA (Wed, AMC) — covered above. Around it, a heavy tech + retail + Canadian-bank slate that fleshes out the AI and consumer reads.

- **AI / software / semis:** NVDA, **Marvell (MRVL, Thu)**, Salesforce (CRM), CrowdStrike (CRWD), Workday (WDAY), Autodesk (ADSK), Synopsys (SNPS), Okta, Veeva, Nutanix, Elastic, SentinelOne, HPQ — the AI-spend and enterprise-software pulse.
- **Consumer / retail (post-Walmart miss):** Dick's (DKS), Abercrombie (ANF), Kohl's (KSS), Williams-Sonoma (WSM), **Ulta (ULTA)**, Dollar General (DG), Dollar Tree (DLTR), Best Buy (BBY), Burlington, Gap — the tell on whether the consumer is cracking.
- **Financials / other:** Canadian banks (RY, TD, BNS, BMO, CM), Intuit (INTU), Zoom, Affirm (AFRM), Li Auto (LI), PDD.

> **Watch:** NVDA guidance sets the index; MRVL/semis confirm or refute; the retail cluster tells you if Walmart's soft comps were company-specific or a consumer signal.

CATALYSTS & EVENTS

- **NVIDIA (Wed AMC)** — the week's dominant single-stock catalyst.
- **Jackson Hole Symposium (Thu–Sat, 27–29 Aug)** — Warsh keynote Friday.
- **Treasury auctions:** 2Y ($69B, Tue), 5Y ($70B, Wed), 7Y ($44B, Thu) — duration supply into a fragile long end.
- **Conferences:** Jefferies Semis, IT Hardware & Comm Tech (25–26 Aug, Chicago); Stifel Tech Executive Summit (25–26 Aug, Deer Valley).
- **Crypto policy:** Senate push on the **CLARITY Act** (market-structure bill) — a live driver behind the BTC surge.
- **Month-end (Mon 31 Aug):** pension/rebalancing flows build late week; China August PMIs the same day.

RATES, CURRENCIES & COMMODITIES

Rates: 10Y at **4.71%** (Hedgeye range 4.64–4.74, TREND up), 2Y at **4.24%** — a bear-steepener with the **30Y near a two-decade high**. The long-end and this week's auctions are the market's central nervous system.

Currencies: DXY ~**98.8** (range 98.24–99.91, TREND down), near a three-month low, with official yen/peso-intervention talk in the mix. **USD/JPY** into Tokyo CPI (Fri) is the FX event to watch; a hawkish Warsh is the dollar's upside catalyst.

Commodities: Gold ~**$4,645** (broke above the 4,322–4,617 range — momentum), Silver ~**$69** (64–71), WTI ~**$86.5** (81.25–87.92) and Brent ~**$93.6**; Copper bullish, Nat Gas bearish. Precious metals and energy are the regime-consistent longs.

HEDGEYE RISK RANGES & REGIME

Regime: #Quad 3 (growth slowing, inflation accelerating) — explicitly the frame in Hedgeye's recent Early Looks ("#Quad3 Bonds, Oil, Consumer…", 18 Aug). Source: Hedgeye **Early Look, "A Parable Of An Old Fisherman," 21 Aug 2026** (Sam Rahman). Ranges are immediate-term.

Instrument	Immediate-term range	TREND
UST 10Y Yield	4.64–4.74	BULLISH
High Yield (HYG)	79.41–79.83	BULLISH
IG Corp (LQD)	105.4–106.8	BEARISH
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,610–7,835	BULLISH
Nasdaq Comp (COMPQ)	25,813–26,798	BULLISH
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2,976–3,073	BULLISH
Health Care (XLV)	168–176	BULLISH
S&P Equal-Weight (RSP)	219.0–225.0	BULLISH
Tech-Software (IGV)	99.0–107.0	BULLISH
Volatility (VIX)	13.90–16.54	BEARISH
US Dollar (DXY)	98.24–99.91	BEARISH
WTI Crude	81.25–87.92	BULLISH
Nat Gas	2.62–2.91	BEARISH
Gold	4,322–4,617	BULLISH
Copper	6.46–6.70	BULLISH
Silver	64–71	BULLISH

Where we sit / what would change it: The map is Quad-3 constructive on hard assets (gold, silver, copper, WTI all bullish) and defensives/equal-weight, bearish USD, bearish IG duration (LQD) and bearish VIX — i.e. own the inflation, fade the dollar and long-duration IG. **Gold has already broken above the top of its range**, a momentum signal but also stretched. The regime flips if growth data (PCE, confidence, claims) soften enough to pull inflation expectations lower — a shift toward Quad 4 — or if a hawkish Warsh + hot PCE drives the long end sharply higher and breaks the equity ranges to the downside.

POSITIONING & THEMES

- **Crowded:** mega-cap AI/semis into NVDA; the long-USD unwind. Hedgeye's high-beta momentum basket was **collapsing (-7.3% DoD)** on 20 Aug — momentum is being taken out.
- **Stretched:** long-duration tech against a rising long end; gold above the top of its risk range.
- **Volatility / credit:** VIX ~**15.4** is cheap given three tier-1 events in five days — optionality is inexpensive. Credit split: **HYG bullish, LQD bearish** (high yield resilient, IG hurt by duration).

> **Tells to watch:** the 30Y yield, USD/JPY, gold, semis breadth (SNDK/MU/MRVL), and whether the high-beta momentum bleed stabilizes or accelerates.

GEOPOLITICS — WHAT'S LIVE

US–Iran is the dominant thread: a reinstated blockade, threats of the “toughest financial penalties in history” and an “economic D-Day,” with Iran vowing a “devastating” response and signing a preferential trade deal with Oman. The administration's stated aim is maximum economic pressure to avoid a “large-scale kinetic restart.”

Market channel: oil and the Strait of Hormuz. Any supply-disruption headline is an inflation/vol catalyst; any de-escalation is the risk-on fade.

Prediction markets: Polymarket ~**88.8% for zero Fed cuts in 2026** reflects the oil-inflation bind. Also live: the Senate **CLARITY Act** crypto vote. Verify odds live.

ASIA SETUP — MONDAY OPEN

Asia should open **modestly firmer** on Friday's Wall Street rebound and the Treasury-buyback backstop, but with conviction capped ahead of NVDA and Jackson Hole. **KOSPI** remains a Hedgeye favorite (KM's Top 3, 21 Aug); Korean and Taiwanese semis will trade off the NVDA setup. Watch **USD/JPY** and the JGB long end (global bond stress is not just a US story), gold and energy names bid, and Chinese equities into month-end and the 31 Aug PMIs. Nikkei stays sensitive to yen-intervention talk.

BEYOND THE MARKETS — COMING UP

- **US Open Tennis (NYC):** Fan Week 23–29 Aug; the main singles draw opens Sun 30 Aug — billed as the longest edition in tournament history.
- **Games:** Metal Gear Solid Master Collection Vol. 2 and Star Wars Zero Company (27 Aug); Elden Ring Tarnished Edition on Switch 2 and Captain Tsubasa II (28 Aug).
- **Film:** late-August theatrical slate (e.g., new horror/genre releases); confirm local dates.
- **Econ-culture:** Jackson Hole doubles as the calendar's marquee gathering — the economics world's late-summer set piece.

SOURCES

CNBC, Reuters, Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, Zacks, CMC Markets, IG, ActionForex, The Globe and Mail; Investrade/Hammerstone weekly event calendar; Trading Economics; FXStreet; Polymarket; Hedgeye (Early Look, KM's Top 3, MOMO Tracker — 21 Aug 2026); company IR / earnings calendars; Tennis Majors / WTA; GameSpot. Figures reflect Friday 21 Aug 2026 data and scheduled events for the week of 24 Aug; **verify live prices and confirm scheduled times before acting.**